Stories & Strategies

The Most Trusted Person in the World is the Podcaster





My points today

1. The TRUST infrastructure your clients rely on is eroding, and podcasting is one of the few channels rebuilding it
2. Are PR pros using podcasts?
3. Most of your clients are:
   - ✓ Afraid to start a podcast because it's complex or there are already too many
   - ✓ They ARE Podcasting but it takes a lot of time, and we aren't getting many downloads and results are hard to prove
4. The reasons most branded podcasts fail

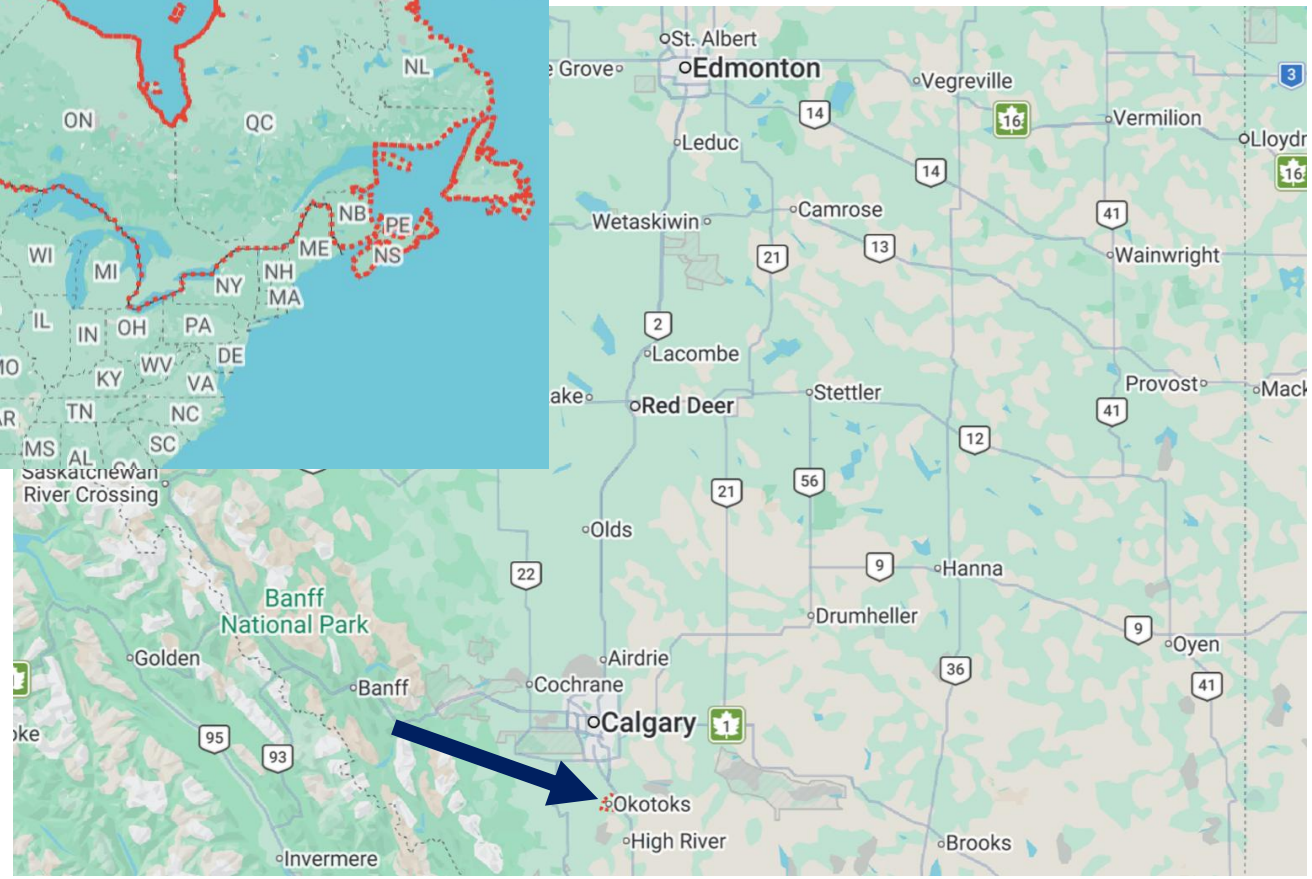


Carlin Lutzer



Lives in Okotoks Canada





Population 30k

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Carlin works in Real Estate

I want to make a podcast.
About Real Estate.
So I can make $$

Meet the Team

Return to



CARLIN LUTZER

REALTOR®

Calgary, Okotoks and Surrounding areas

carlin@carlinlutzer.com

Cell: 403 700 0303

Pager: 403 271 0600

Languages: English

Categories: Residential, Rural

Visit my Website

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A show about real estate that doesn't talk about real estate



Who is listening?



First episode
April 12, 2025

Doing the Work





















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Local Newspaper

Western Wheel

Okotoks' first podcast is giving a voice to locals

Carlin Lutzer launched The Okotoks Podcast in April to share candid conversations with a variety of community members.



Mathew Pitt
Jun 14, 2025 1:00 PM



Doing the Work





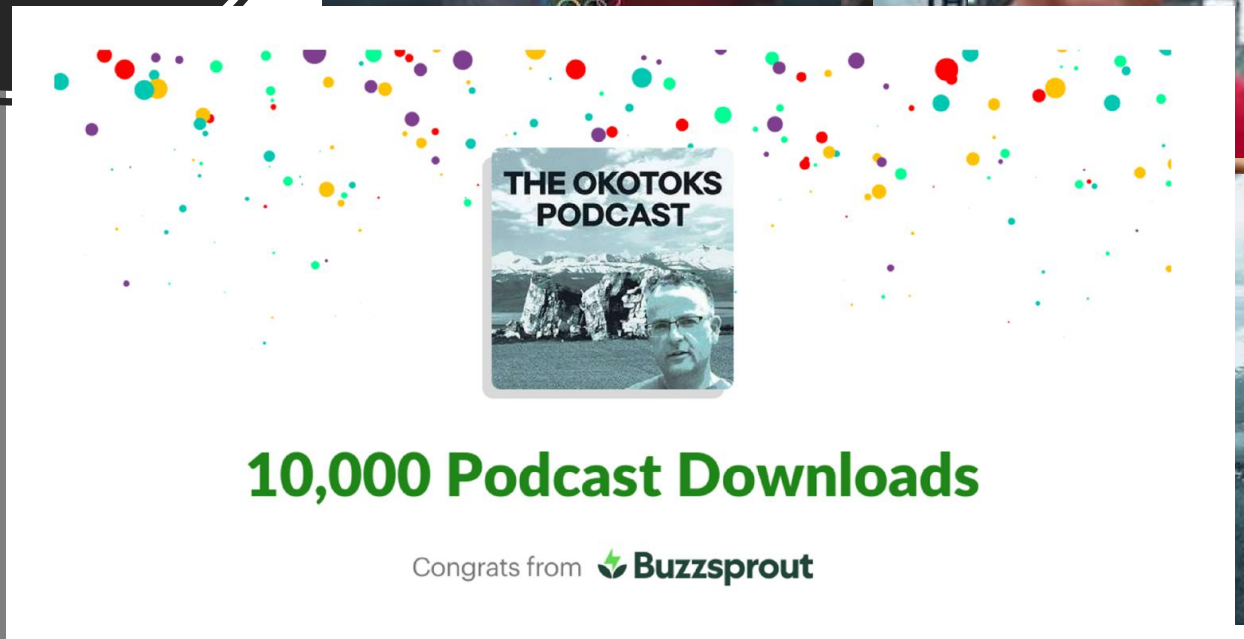
















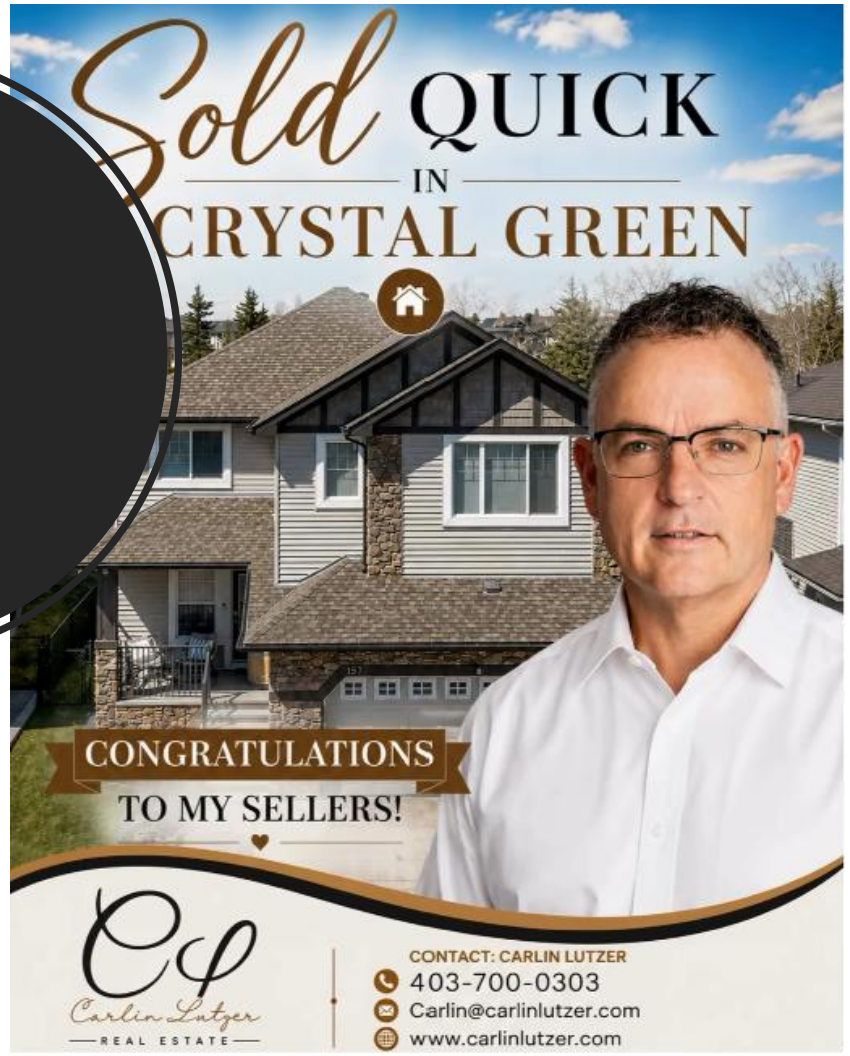


Rotary
Club of Okotoks

Local Celebrity



KPIs



- Has sold several homes each $2M+ as direct result of podcast
  - Several more in the works
- Is now monetizing on YouTube
- People come to open houses he hosts just to meet him
- Hosts local events
- Council electees and candidates seek him out
- Local Chamber of Commerce has asked him to moderate next civic electoral debate
- Website visits 4x
- Is the source for people in Okotoks to come to when they want to know what's going on (Good and Bad)
- ***"The amount of people I've gotten to know in town as a result of this podcast is unbelievable"***



Today

Podcasting is the most powerful trust-building medium of our time

And the most under-leveraged tool in the communications strategist's arsenal

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Podcast Hosts Build Unusually High Trust

The Most Trusted

81%

of creator-show fans say they trust their favourite creator
as much as, or more than, close friends

52% vs 24%

weekly podcast consumers say podcast hosts influence them more than
social media influencers

75%

of podcast listeners say they trust the hosts they listen to

For comparison

17% rate newspaper reporters highly for honesty and ethics

12% say the same of business executives

These studies do not prove podcast hosts are literally the most trusted people in the world. They do show podcast hosts rank as exceptionally trusted and influential voices.

Sources

Wondery / SmithGeiger, 2026
Cumulus Media / Signal Hill Insights, Spring 2026
Deloitte Digital Media Trends, 2023
Gallup Honesty & Ethics, 2025

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November Vogue Magazine



FASHION INDUSTRY TRENDS

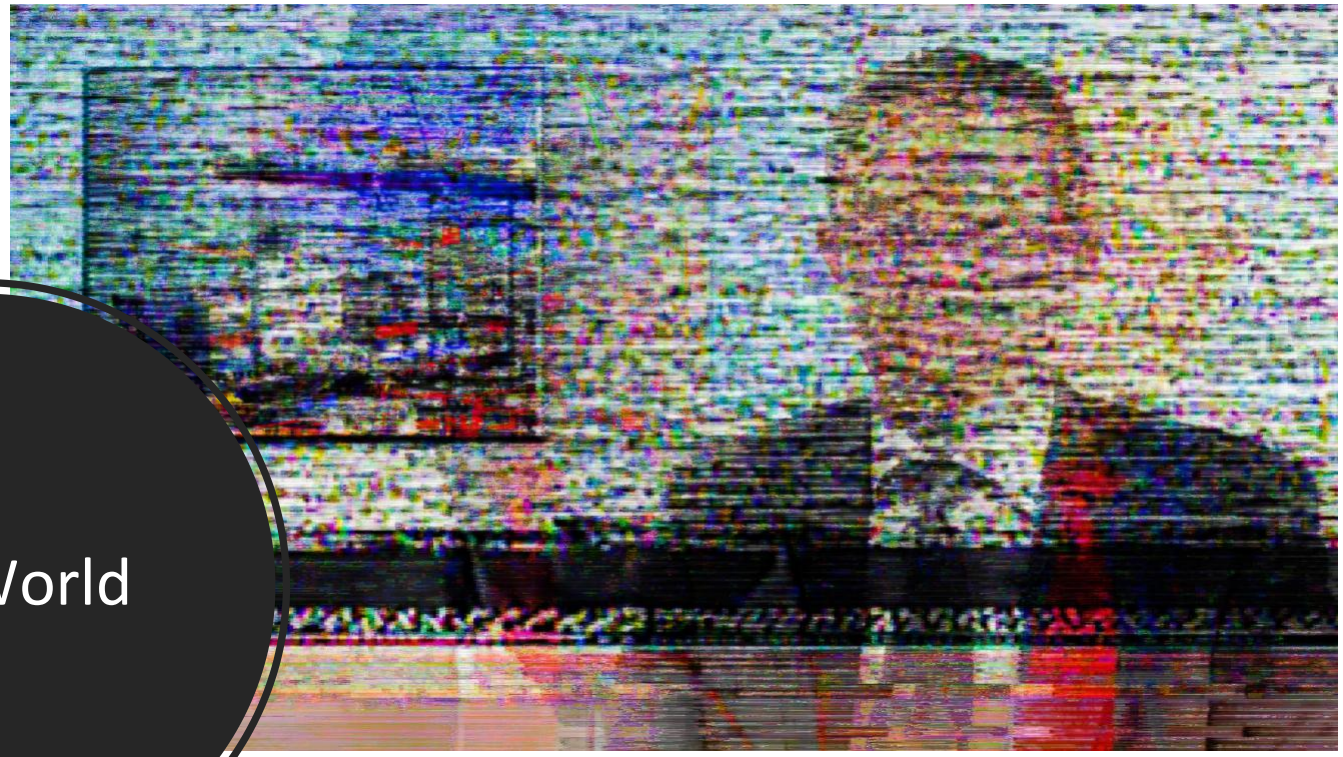
As Podcasters Become Cultural Juggernauts, Brands Should Probably Tune In

BY LUCY MAGUIRE

November 9, 2026

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Our World



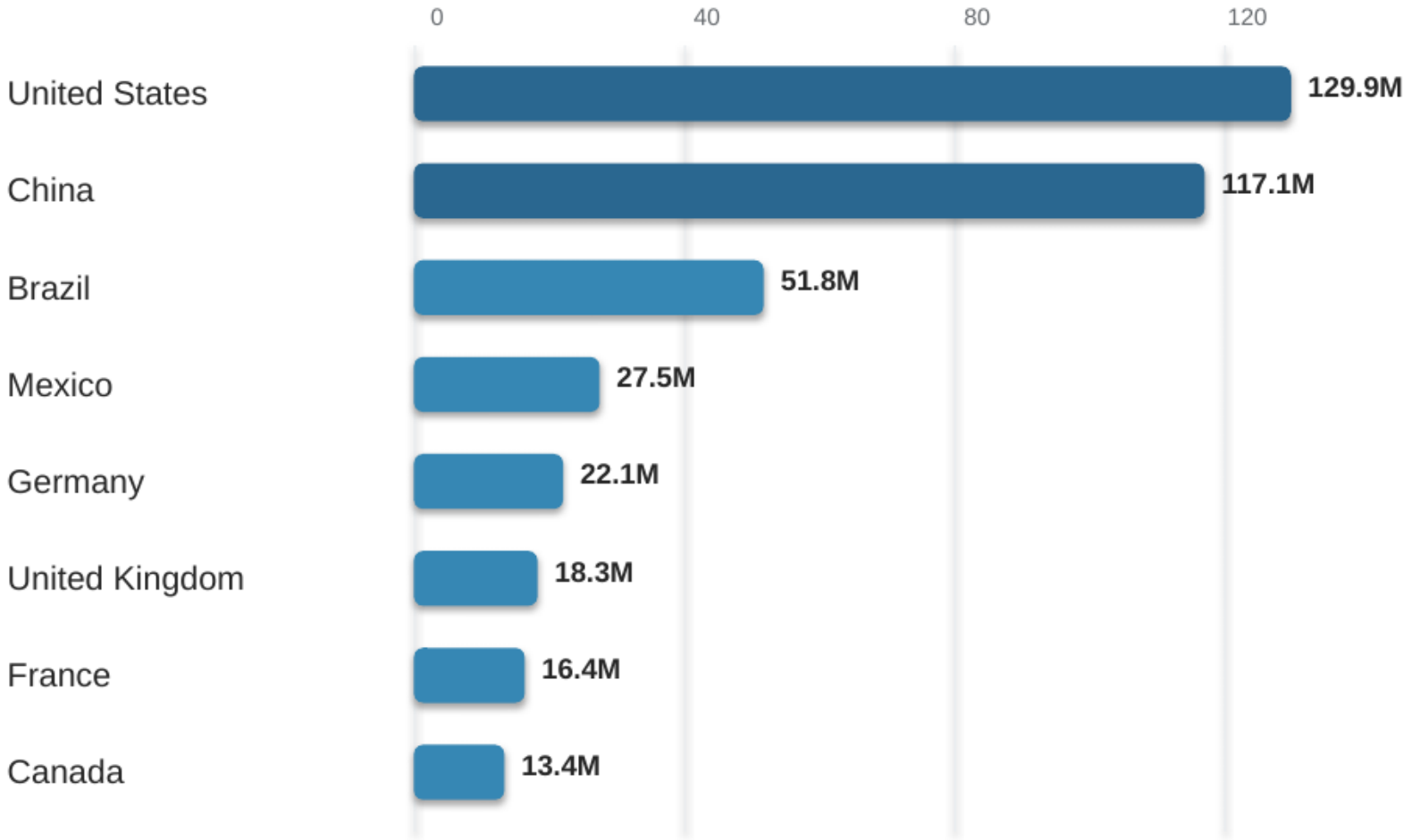
- Trust is breaking down in the AI era
- Traditional channels are losing credibility
- Podcasting reaches people in focused moments
- Long-form, opt-in listening builds connection
- Voice and conversation signal real authenticity



Global Podcast Audiences

The World's Largest Podcast Audiences

Estimated monthly listeners, millions | selected markets | 2024



Note: Selected published countries only; not a definitive global ranking.

Sources: EMARKETER, 2024 estimates; Search Engine Land, "Podcast statistics you need to know in 2026."

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Nigeria: Scale Meets Podcast Engagement

A large connected population and unusually frequent podcast listening

Nigeria: A Major Market

109M

INTERNET USERS

End of 2025

25.2%

LISTEN WEEKLY

Internet users 16+; Q3 2024

2.86

DAYS PER WEEK

Average podcast listening; Q2 2025

Nigerians report listening on nearly twice as many days as Americans.

Nigeria 2.86 • United States 1.47 • Canada 1.28 days per week

These figures are different measures and cannot be multiplied into a verified listener count.

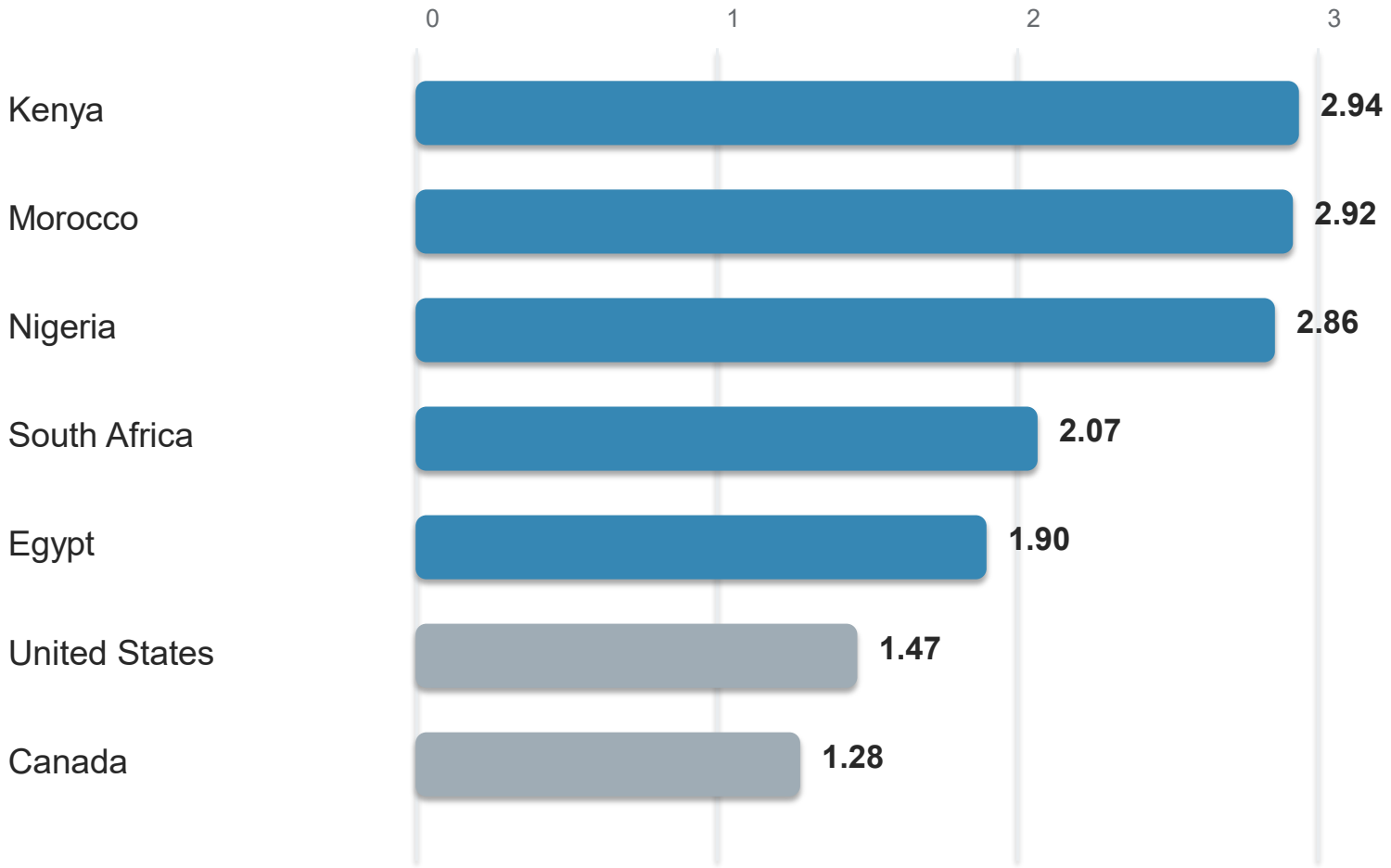
Sources: DataReportal Digital 2026 Nigeria; GWI Digital 2025 (Q3 2024); GWI Digital 2026 (Q2 2025, p. 331).

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African Podcast Engagement

African Markets Lead in Listening Frequency

Average days per week listening to podcasts | internet users aged 16+ | Q2 2025



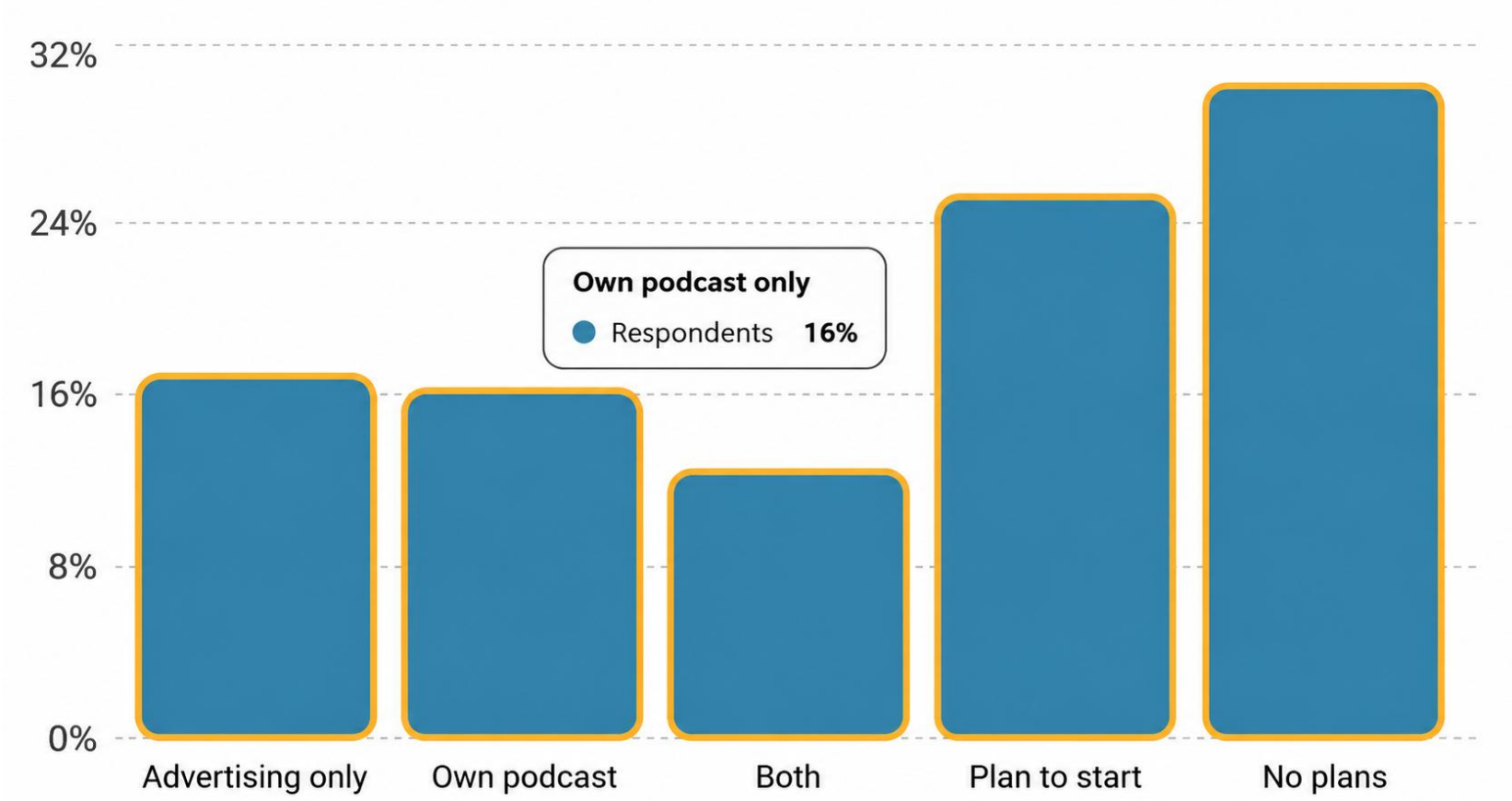
Listening frequency, not total number of listeners or listening hours.

Source: GWI (Q2 2025), Digital 2026 Global Overview Report, p. 331, via DataReportal / Meltwater.

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OUTCOMES ROCKET

Are PR Pros Using Podcasts?

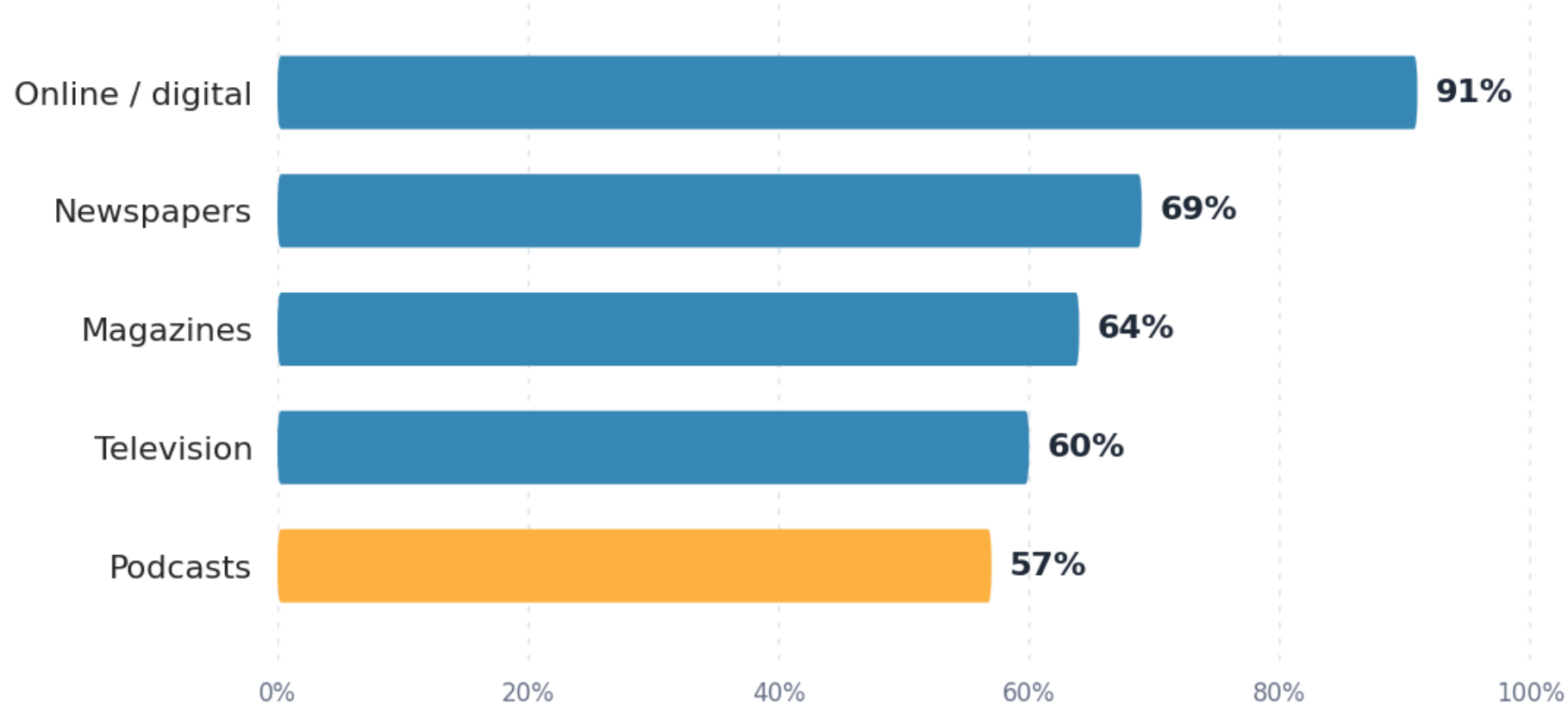


This Study Includes Marketing Pros

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MUCK RACK

Where do PR Pros Pitch?



Source: Muck Rack, State of PR 2026 • Predominantly US-based respondents • Multiple selections allowed

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The Opportunity for Brands

- Branding stands out from content
- 94% of listeners consume podcasts while performing other tasks
  - +18% engagement
  - +40% emotional intensity
  - +22% long-term memory
- They are consumed in ways that are addictive to the mix
- The language of a podcast creates subconscious associations with the brand
- Podcasts are a particularly effective way to reach ad avoiders
- Podcasts provide extra time for brands



https://www.bbc.co.uk/mediacentre/worldnews/2019/audio-activated

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Soooo many podcasts now

Total podcasts in the index ...

4,756,645



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9 out of 10 quit

Total podcasts in the index ...

4,756,645

Shows published in the last ...

3 DAYS	10 DAYS	30 DAYS	60 DAYS	90 DAYS
85,267	241,056	346,098	413,990	469,963



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Top Reasons Brands Quit



1. No Clear Outcome
2. Unrealistic Growth Expectations
3. Inconsistent Production System
4. Time + Cost > Perceived Return
5. Poor Audience Understanding/Targeting
6. Don’t Listen to/Analyze Audience
7. Burnout from Overproduction
8. Guest Dependency (if interview-based)
9. Loss of Intrinsic Motivation
10. No Strategic Integration



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KPIs / Measurement

Classic Podcast KPIs

Downloads
Listeners and Unique Listeners
Total Time Listened Monthly
Episode Retention Rates
Follower/Subscriber Growth/Churn
Audience Demographics
Listening Platforms
Chart Appearances
New Reviews
New Ratings
Social/Personal Engagement
Listicle Appearances
Dream Guests
Show mentioned in other Media
New Social Media followers
Website visits



Specific KPIs

New social media followers (attributable to podcast or content generated by podcast)
Newsletter signups
SEO/AEO/GEO strength
Awards
Speaking engagements / Media interviews
Strong strategic integration with other brand channels and backlinks
Develop relationships with key people (guests)
Learn more within your field talking with other experts
Competitive intelligence gathered
Market validation of new ideas
CRM contacts added from podcast
Academy / Masterclass registration measured through tracking links
Tracking whether contacts at target accounts are listening
Shortened sales cycles (is the podcast doing the heavy lifting early?)
Podcast-influenced pipeline value

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NIGERIAN PODCAST INDEX

Now Nigeria

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Source Spotlight: Tony Doe

Research behind this presentation's Nigerian podcasting insights

Tony Onwuchekwa (Tony Doe)

Founder, *Nigerian Podcast Index*

Publisher, *Into the Podverse*

- He is the creator and author of the **Nigerian Podcast Index,** a public directory and research resource documenting podcasts created in Nigeria and by Nigerians.
- The **2026 Nigerian Podcast Index Industry Report** was used as a key source for ecosystem statistics in this presentation.
- The **2023 study "Podcast Listening Habits in Nigeria"** was also used for listener demographic context.
- Together, these sources helped inform the Nigerian podcast figures and audience insights referenced in this deck.

Sources used in this deck

- Nigerian Podcast Index Industry Report 2026
- Podcast Listening Habits in Nigeria (2023)
- substack.com/@intothepodverse

Scan to visit Tony Doe's Substack

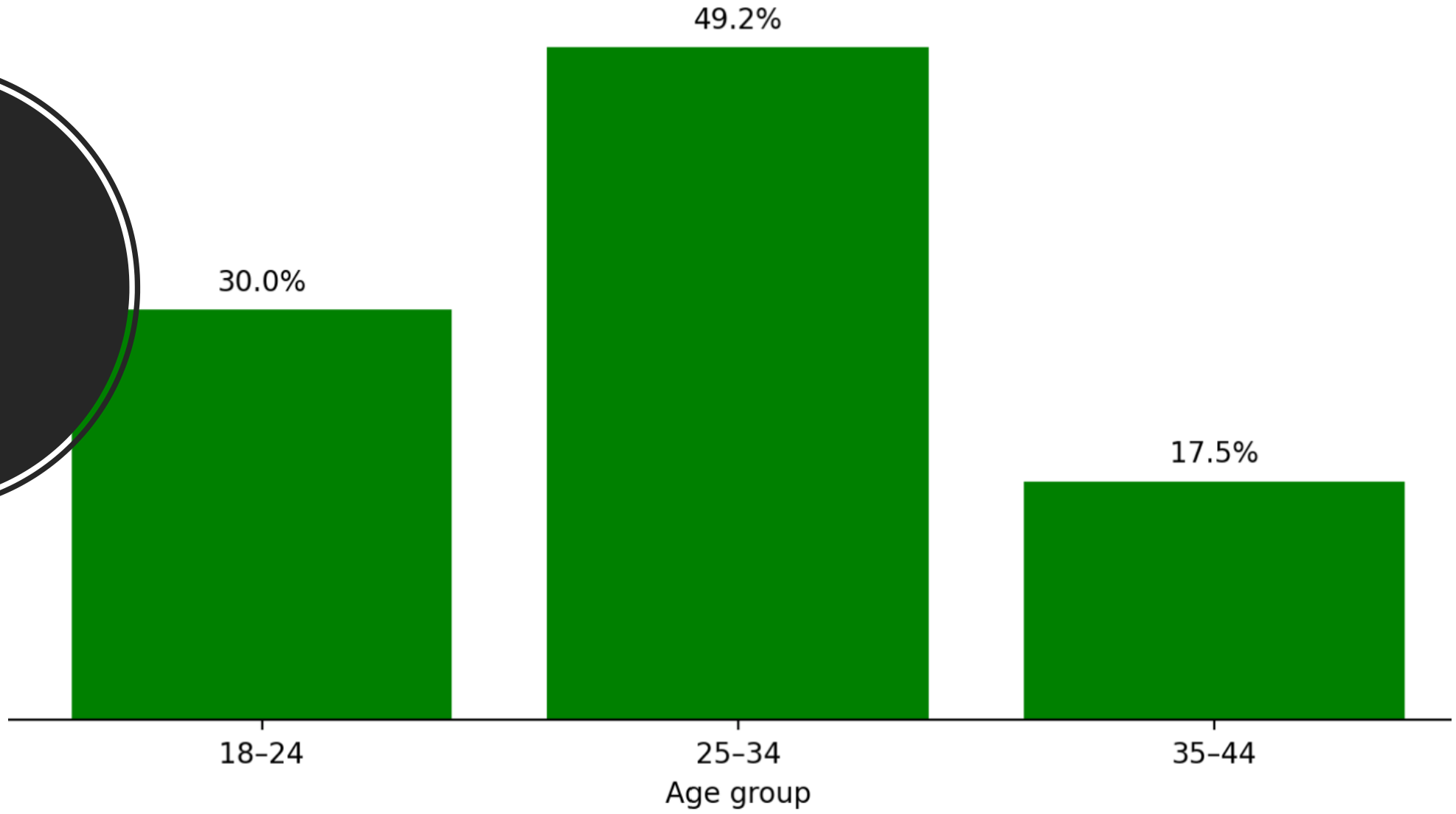
NIGERIAN PODCAST INDEX

Now Nigeria

- 604 Nigerian podcasts (+83% from 329 in 2025)
- Only 44% are active (268 – basically same as 2025)
- Society & Culture (172 shows), religion & spirituality (108), business (73), education (48), and news (27)
- Lagos (77 shows – leading hub), 97 shows about Nigeria produced internationally
- English (93%), Igbo, Yoruba, Hausa, Pidgin a handful each

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Ages



Listening Frequency



Podcasts Build Community



- Podcasts build unparalleled Trust
- Underutilized by Public Relations
- A branded podcast isn’t about chasing the biggest audience… it’s about reaching the right one
- When listeners feel connected, the audience becomes community/advocates

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Connect

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Podcast Production for Influential Brands



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